in the online archives of the Ronald Reagan Presidential Library and Museum, declassified reports and dossiers of the Central Intelligence Agency (CIA), as well as UK Foreign Office Files for India, Pakistan and Afghanistan, 1947–80, offer insights into Anglo-American decision-making on India-Pakistan-Afghanistan relations. From the Indian side, the P. N. Haksar papers, Selected Works of Jawaharlal Nehru (SWJN), and documents related to the Transfer of Power to India (all available at the Nehru Memorial Museum and Library in New Delhi) help recounting the history of India-Afghanistan relations before 1979.

Diplomatic memos leaked by Wikileaks, though selective in their coverage, offer rich behind-the-scenes insights into US diplomacy with India, Afghanistan, and Pakistan. While the Kissinger Cables do this for the early 1970s, the Carter cables and the Carter cables 2 offer such insights for the late-1970s and early 1980s. The *Afghan War Diary* as well as the Cablegate documents shed light on Indian engagement with the US between 2002 and 2011 on wide-ranging geopolitical issues. Official Indian documents such as the foreign affairs records (FAR), the annual reports of the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA), and the debates (and questions) in the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha, provide priceless details that often go unnoticed in popular analyses. Critically, the parliamentary debates indicate where and how Afghanistan figured in the discussions of India's political elite. India's interventions on the situation in Afghanistan at the UN show how India's position evolved at multilateral forums on the issue of reconciling with the Taliban. Autobiographies and diaries of senior Indian, Pakistani, Afghan, British, and American officials, on the other hand, throw light on how these figures viewed, and acted upon, relevant political developments. Reports published by the *Times of India* (ToI), *The Hindu*, the *Indian Express*, the *New York Times*, the *Guardian*, the BBC, Frontline, Outlook, and *Afghan Islamic Press* (a Taliban mouthpiece), help outline key trends of South Asian geopolitics.

A series of interviews conducted by the author further inform this book. Interviewees include middle- and top-level political, military, intelligence, and diplomatic officials in India, Afghanistan, UK, and the US, as well as some Afghan Taliban leaders and combatants.[30] For a variety of reasons, the author was unable to visit Pakistan for fieldwork, even though the Pakistani perspective on India's role in Afghanistan is well accounted for and appreciated in the book.